

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

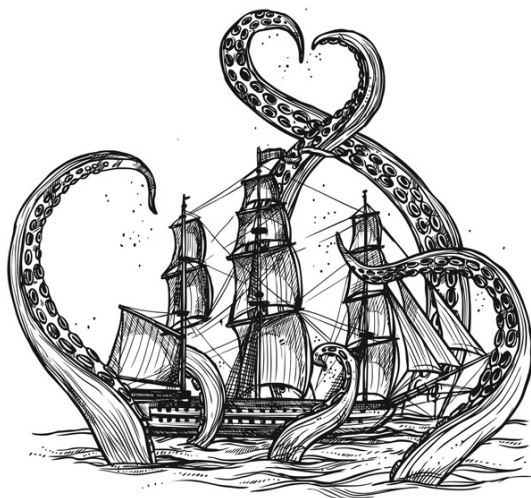
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Let's Start!

Special effects in films are fascinating!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about art, science, exploration, beliefs and opinions.
- I can express that I have no influence over whether a condition will be fulfilled.
- I can talk about two actions together.

Ask your partner:

- What film has had the best special effects so far in your opinion?
- What new effects would you like to see in films in the future?





Let's Explore!

How many FX films can you **cite***?

* When you "cite" something, you name or quote it.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Supposing you are to make a movie, how will you spend the money? If you are to have special effects, what type will they be? Creating special effects is becoming more and more common in the movie industry. Were you to come up with some of the more famous special effects, what movies would they be from? In early films like *The Ten Commandments* special effects artists spent money on constructing a U-shaped water tank to film the parting of the sea. Since then moviemakers have succeeded in producing even more amazing effects, depending on having enough time and money, of course.

Stars now adjust to acting with green screens. Were I to cite films whose effects have filled us with wonder, I would start with *Avatar* and *The Life of Pi*. Were it not for the magic, these films would not have been the same. With *Avatar*, James Cameron put off starting the film until new techniques had advanced far enough to portray his vision. In *The Life of Pi* they succeeded in combining green screens and animation. This succeeded in opening a new chapter in filmmaking. The sky, it seems, is now the limit. Were I to open up the list to other FX epics, I am sure they would offer up *Jurassic* anything, *Independence Day*, *Alien* and its siblings, *Transformers* and any superhero saga.

We are now used to having our superheroes really fly. We believe in demanding the best, most up-to-date effects. We complain profusely about watching anything slightly mediocre. Supposing you subject a group of teens to a series of classic black and white films, what would their reaction be? Disbelief, anger, boredom? We are jaded by the ultra-heightened suspension of reality. *Casablanca* just doesn't have the bells and whistles.





Let's Practice!

These are expressions you use and hear when talking about art, science, exploration, beliefs and opinions.

Instructions: Read the clues. Find the words in the word search below.

1. to build (C _ _ S T _ _ _ _)
2. characters in stories or movies who have special powers, help people, and fight evil.
(S _ P _ _ _ E _ O)
3. with a large amount of something
(P R _ F _ _ E _ _)
4. acceptable, but not enough
(_ E _ I O _ _ E)
5. lacking interest or desire because of having experienced so much
(J _ _ _ D)
6. the act of stopping or freezing
(_ U S _ _ _ _ I _ N)

A	D	V	N	Y	J	G	T	J	L	N	O	A	X	C	J	S	D
E	S	Y	H	J	L	N	N	P	D	R	H	J	K	L	A	S	V
I	X	S	V	C	X	G	U	K	B	N	M	W	Q	R	D	B	J
O	C	F	B	N	O	S	D	J	K	E	W	A	V	D	E	H	D
O	D	N	S	W	G	N	G	D	J	S	E	R	S	B	D	K	F
Y	E	W	D	O	X	F	S	S	V	B	X	V	N	H	D	C	N
L	B	F	J	R	H	J	X	T	G	A	D	F	J	K	G	P	D
E	Z	S	A	E	L	K	X	B	R	N	G	F	S	F	W	A	D
S	X	B	D	H	O	K	B	Z	X	U	D	J	K	L	G	Q	S
U	C	T	F	R	T	H	N	D	N	B	C	N	B	V	S	X	I
F	G	V	G	E	E	F	K	C	A	E	I	T	O	U	S	D	E
O	J	T	H	P	E	N	F	Y	G	G	T	G	V	V	M	B	R
R	L	H	H	U	T	D	S	F	S	G	H	S	D	H	Z	X	C
P	H	S	U	S	P	E	N	S	I	O	N	J	E	T	Y	U	O
T	G	H	J	V	B	A	W	E	T	F	J	A	B	K	S	C	I
G	D	R	Y	B	D	I	H	K	O	S	V	D	Y	D	D	H	D
H	S	R	R	F	S	H	K	G	J	G	X	S	G	D	F	K	E
U	A	D	U	G	D	C	V	F	F	R	D	R	U	F	V	H	M



Let's Practice!

Let's talk about film making.

Instructions: Use the options from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

what movies would they be from / what type will they be / what would their reaction be / how would you spend the money

1. Supposing you are to make a movie, _____?
2. If you are to have special effects, _____?
3. If you were to choose some of the more famous special effects, _____?
4. Supposing you subject a group of teens to a series of classic black and white films, _____?





Extension Activity

Look at the special effects of the past.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to the library and find out how early films produced special effects.
- Look at the year they were produced.
- Find out how the films were received and whether people were excited about the special effects then.
- Prepare a short talk on how special effects and the way they are received have changed.
- Present your ideas with a group or a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I find out how early films produced special effects.

☐ ☐

I find out how the films were received and whether people were excited about the special effects then.

☐ ☐

I prepare a short talk on special effects.

☐ ☐

I share my ideas with a partner or group

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to construct** (verb): to build
e.g. In early films like *The Ten Commandments* special effects artists spent money on constructing a U-shaped water tank to film the parting of the sea.
- bells and whistles** (expression): special features added to attract customers
e.g. *Casablanca* just doesn't have the bells and whistles.
- superhero** (noun): characters in stories or movies who have special powers, help people, and fight evil
e.g. We are now used to having our superheros really fly.
- profusely** (adverb): with a large amount of something
e.g. Tom complained profusely about watching the movie.
- mediocre** (adjective): acceptable, but not enough
e.g. This movie is mediocre at best.
- jaded** (adjective): lacking interest or desire because of having experienced so much
e.g. We were jaded after watching the horror movie.
- ultra-heightened** (adjective): highly increased
e.g. We have a ultra-heightened sense of paranoia after watching the movie.
- suspension** (noun): the act of stopping or freezing
e.g. You needed a suspension of disbelief when watching the movie.





Learning Points

If ... Are to /Were to

You use *if + am/is/are/were to ...* to suggest that you have very little influence over the outcome of a situation.

If + am/is/are to ... is used to suggest that the condition may or may not be fulfilled.

Example:

If you are to have special effects, what type will they be?

If + were to ... is used to suggest that the condition is very unlikely to be fulfilled.

Example:

If you were to come up with some of the more famous special effects, what movies would they be from?

You can replace *if* with *were*. This is not possible with *am/is/are*.

Examples:

- *Supposing you are to make a movie, how will you spend the money?*
- *Were you to come up with some of the more famous special effects, what movies would they be from?*
- *Were I to cite films whose effects have filled us with wonder, I would start with Avatar and The Life of Pi.*
- *Were it not for the magic, these films would not have been the same.*





Learning Points

Prepositions + -ing

When you talk about two actions linked together, you normally use two verbs. When you use prepositional verbs, the second verb is always in the -ing form.

You can use two verbs to talk about two connected actions. The main verb introduces the main action, and the second verb in the -ing form gives more information about that action.

Prepositional verbs are always followed by another verb in the -ing form like *end up*, *carry on*, *keep on*, *go on*, *succeed in*, *depend on*, *adjust to*, *put off* ...

Structure:

Subject + prepositional verb + -ing form of the second verb

Look at some examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Since then moviemakers have succeeded in producing even more amazing effects, depending on having enough time and money, of course.*
- *Stars now adjust to acting with green screens.*
- *With Avatar, James Cameron put off starting the film until new techniques had advanced far enough to portray his vision.*

